

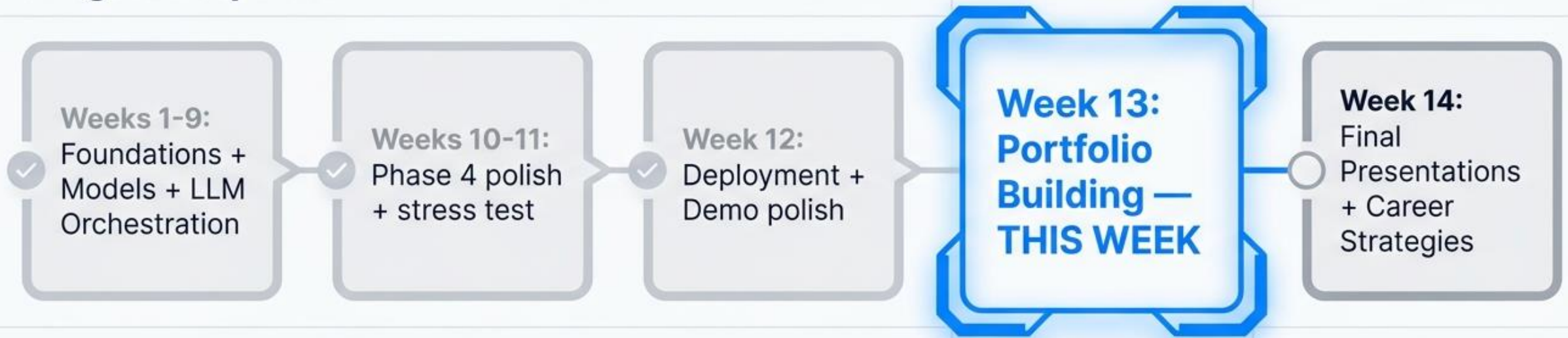
PORTFOLIO BUILDING

WEEK 13: FROM GROUP WORK TO INDIVIDUAL IDENTITY

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE IMMERSION: ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE
JOHN JAY COLLEGE OF CRIMINAL JUSTICE

The final pivot from learning to presenting

Progress Pipeline



You spent 12 weeks building things inside a group repo. Today is about **making YOUR work visible** — under your name, on your profile, where it counts for your career.

Mapping our path to career visibility

01

Why Portfolios Get You Hired

What hiring managers actually look at, how long they spend, and what triggers a “yes interview” signal.

02

Writing That Lands

Blog post structure, LinkedIn posts, and AI-assisted self-critique to make your writing land.

03

In-Class Work Time

Polish your GitHub profile, draft a blog post, or work on extra credit while help is available.

01

Why Portfolios Get You Hired

First, get clear on what you're being hired AS.

You are not applying as a software engineer

Before you build a portfolio, get clear on what role it's for. The work you did this semester positions you as someone who translates business problems into AI solutions.

Software Engineer

- **Hired for:** writing and maintaining code
- **Evaluated on:** code quality, system design, language depth
- **Portfolio shows:** clean code, architecture, library contributions

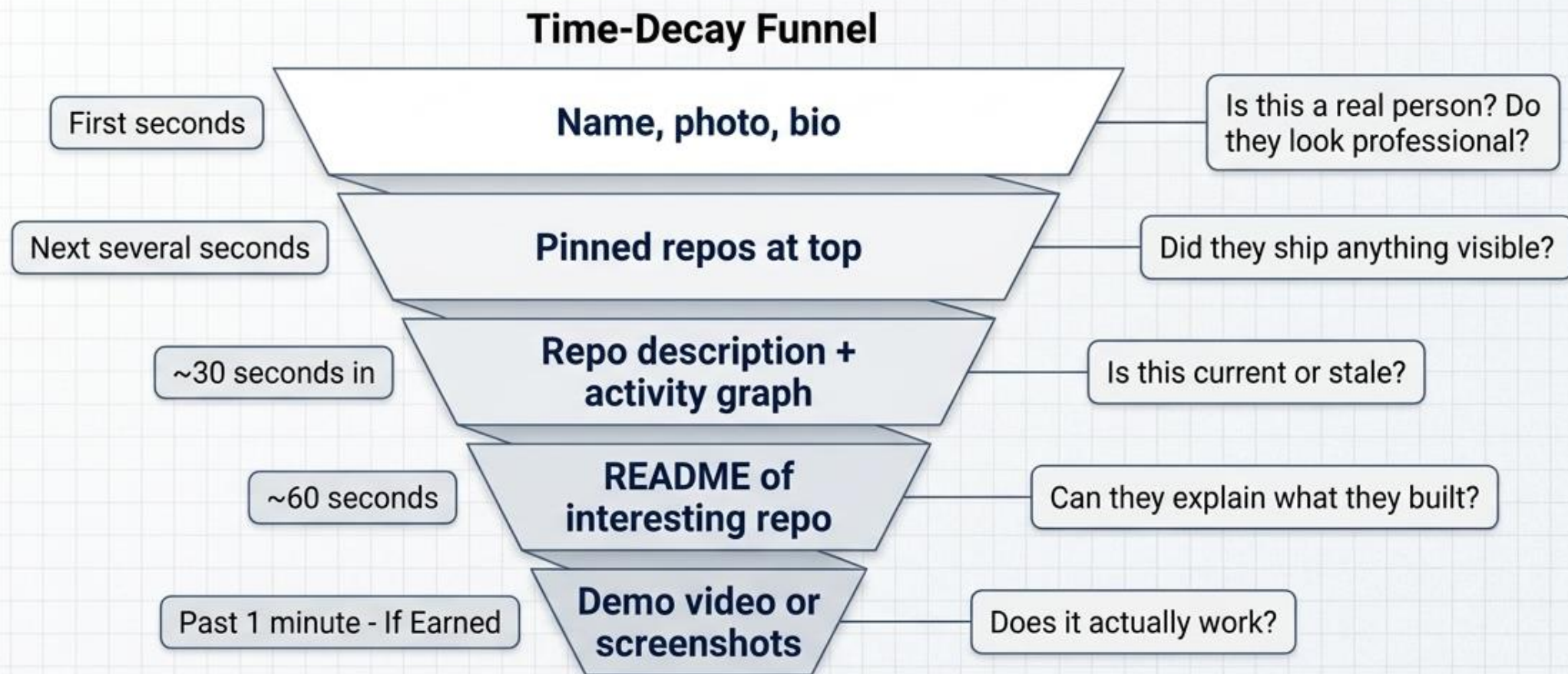
Targeted Roles: AI Integration Specialist, Automation Specialist, Business Analyst (AI focus), Junior Data Analyst, Operations Analyst, Domain Analyst (Fraud, Forensics, Compliance).

AI Integration Specialist

- **Hired for:** turning business problems into working AI solutions using existing tools
- **Evaluated on:** problem framing, tool selection, system thinking, communication
- **Portfolio shows:** deployed workflows, demo videos, READMEs explaining decisions

Your bio, your blog post, your README descriptions — all should reinforce THIS positioning. The next slides are calibrated for this role, not for SWE.

Surviving the hiring manager's 60-second filter



Hiring managers spend under a minute per candidate on first pass. The portfolio's job is to earn the next five minutes — not to communicate everything.

Three signals that actually earn an interview

1. Problem Translation

- Evidence: Working pipeline solving a specific problem.

✓ **Signal:** README opens with the problem, real flow demoed.

✗ **Kill:** "I used Flowise" instead of "I built X to solve Y."

2. Non-Technical Explanation

- Evidence: README intro understood by non-engineers.

✓ **Signal:** Plain-language, concrete outcomes.

✗ **Kill:** Jargon-heavy intros, "AI-driven insights."

3. Tool Judgment

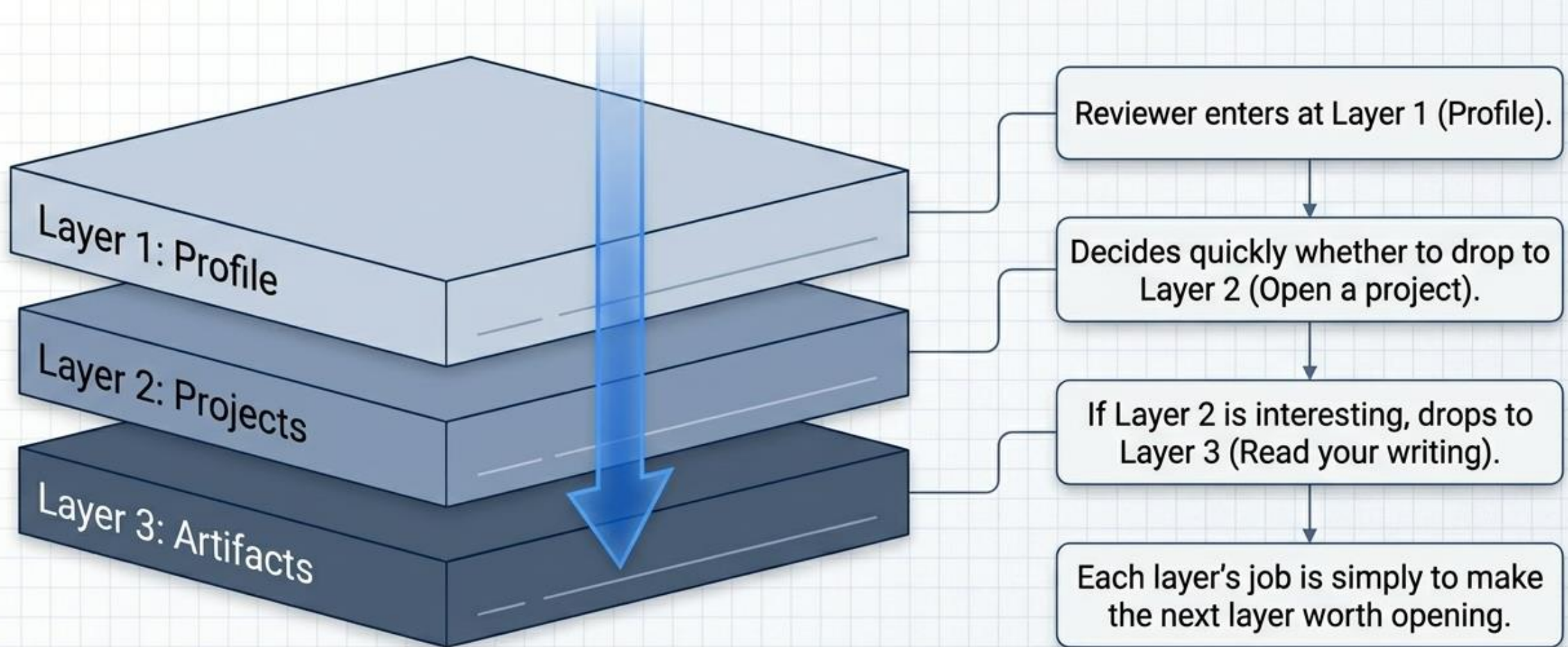
- Evidence: Choices justified, limits acknowledged.

✓ **Signal:** "Why this approach", scope-downs, acknowledging failure modes.

✗ **Kill:** Using LLMs for everything, treating AI as magic.

Notice: Zero of these signals are about code quality. They are about problem understanding, communication, and tool judgment.

The portfolio stack operates as a series of sequential gates



Most students focus entirely on Layer 2 (projects) and ignore Layer 1 (**profile**).
The **profile** is what makes anyone open the project.

Your GitHub profile is your professional identity card

Element	What “Good” Looks Like	What “Weak” Looks Like
Photo/Avatar	✓ Real photo or clean avatar	✗ Default GitHub icon (signals new account)
Display Name	✓ Real name	✗ Username only / xXgamerXx
Bio	✓ “AI integration specialist building no-code pipelines”	✗ “Aspiring developer looking for opportunities”
Location	✓ City or region	✗ Empty
Pinned Repos	✓ 4-6 repos with strong descriptions/demos	✗ Default selection or empty
Visible Activity	✓ Some recent activity in last few months	✗ Abandoned account

Mythbuster

Note: Green-square “contribution streaks” matter less for AI integration roles than for SWE roles. Focus on current READMEs and demos, not daily commits.

The hidden homepage most candidates miss

The Mechanics: The Profile Repository

A special repo named exactly `[your-username]/[your-username]`. Sits at the top of your profile.

- 1 Click (+) New repository.
- 2 Name it your exact username.
- 3 Look for the “secret” message and check “Add a README file”.

The Content Blueprint

GitHub README

- **1-paragraph intro** (who you are, what you focus on).
- **Featured project** (capstone link + 2-sentence description).
- **Skills/tools** (short list of actual tools used, not 50 buzzwords).
- **Links** (LinkedIn, blog, email).
- **Personal touch** (curiosities, current reading).

“This is the highest-leverage 30 minutes you’ll spend. A solid profile README makes you noticeably more polished than the average applicant.”

Strategic allocation of your six pinned slots

UI Spatial Map

Slot 1: Your strongest project (Capstone)

1-2 sentence description naming the problem.

Slots 2-4: Supporting work

Must have problem statement, demo, and working result.

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Slots 5-6: Optional

Leave empty if no substantive work.
Do not pad.

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Do not pad.

Role-Calibrated Mistakes

Mistake 1: Pinning group repos where your specific contribution is unclear (fix: pin a fork or link your subfolder).

Mistake 2: Tool-centric descriptions ("My Flowise chatbot") instead of Problem-centric ("Knowledge assistant for incident response").

Hiring managers care if your README makes them understand what business problem you solved in 15 seconds, not if your code is elegant.

Your 30-minute execution checklist

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ **Photo/Avatar:** Replace the default icon.
- ☐ **Display Name:** Set to real name.
- ☐ **Bio:** Present tense, specific, positioned as AI Integration / Automation Specialist (remove 'aspiring').
- ☐ **Location:** Add city or region.
- ☐ **Pinned Repos:** Select strongest work. Rewrite descriptions to name the PROBLEM, not just tools.
- ☐ **Profile README:** Create the username/username repo and implement the structured template.

Note: These 6 items are the ONLY required lab work this week.

Don't perfect this — improve it. Spend 30 focused minutes and stop. Get from "unfinished" to "professional."

02

Writing That Makes You Hire-able

Blog posts, LinkedIn, and using AI to critique your drafts.

A Blog Post Proves What a Resume Can Only Claim

What a resume shows

- A list of things you did
- Tool keywords (n8n, Airtable, Flowise)
- A grade or a course name
- Unproven claims of collaboration or leadership

What a blog post shows

- How you think through a problem
 - └─ What you decide when there are options
 - └─ How you navigate things that don't work
- Your specific communication style
- Your collaborative voice

A hiring manager can stack-rank resumes in an hour. They cannot stack-rank blog posts the same way. Each post reveals something a resume physically cannot hold.



The Anatomy of a High-Impact Technical Post

The Hook (First 2-3 sentences)

Anchor: Our pipeline classified 87 alerts correctly – and one disastrously wrong.

The Context (1 short paragraph)

Anchor: Phishing detection system for a fictional 200-person company... Built with three teammates.

The Why (1-2 paragraphs)

Anchor: We picked Groq over OpenAI because the free tier let us iterate... The tradeoff: smaller context window.

The Hard Part (1-2 paragraphs)

Anchor: 'Complete' vs 'complete' silently broke our pipeline for two days.

What You'd Do Differently (1 paragraph)

Anchor: We should have used confidence routing from day one instead of bolting it on.

The Close (2-3 sentences)

Anchor: Project link, next steps. Avoid generic "Thanks for reading!"

The First Two Sentences Dictate the Entire Read

Hooks That Fail

"In this post, I will discuss the project I built for my AI Workshop course..."

[The Academic: Vague, lacks tension]

"I'm excited to share my capstone project!"

[The Excitable: Centers writer's feelings, not reader's interest]

"AI is transforming the world. In this project, I explored..."

[The Generic: Applies to absolutely anyone's project]

Hooks That Connect

"Our phishing detection pipeline misclassified the same email three times in a row – even though a human could spot the scam in less than a second."

[The Specific Failure: Creates instant curiosity]

"When I joined the team, we had four people, four components, and zero agreement on the database schema. Our final design looks nothing like our starting point."

[The Team Tension: Specific friction]

If your hook could apply to anyone's project, it is not a hook.
Specific beats clever every time.

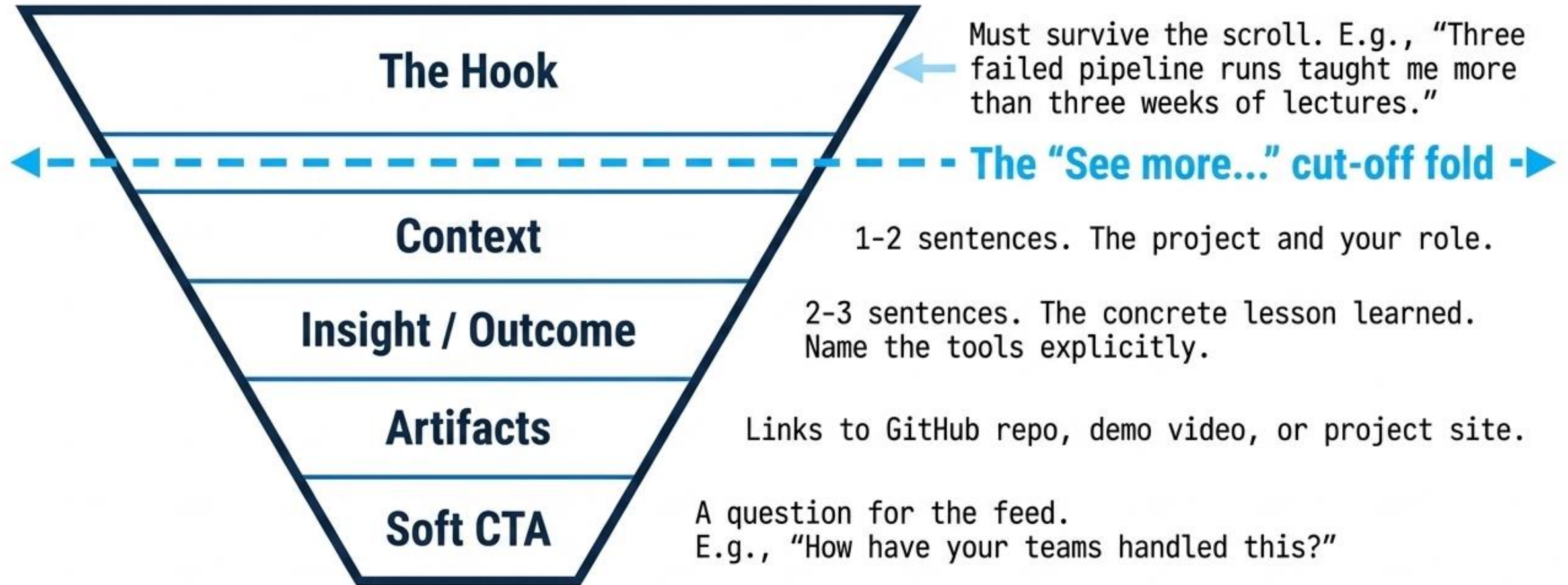
Strategic Deployment: Match the Platform to the Goal

Your Goal	Best Choice	The Rationale
Simplest path, zero friction	BLOG.md in capstone repo	Renders perfectly on GitHub, links directly from your README.
Professional visibility	LinkedIn Article	Hits the exact same network as your career updates.
Reach technical readers	Dev.to	Active developer community, visible without needing a prior following.
Build broader presence	Medium	Wider audience, but introduces paywalls and slower initial growth.
Long-term personal brand	Personal Site (GitHub Pages)	Most professional and future-proof, but requires initial setup.

There is no 'best' platform – only the correct platform for your immediate goal.

A LinkedIn Post Operates on a Two-Second Scroll Reality

A blog post assumes a 5-minute commitment. A LinkedIn post assumes a 2-second audition.



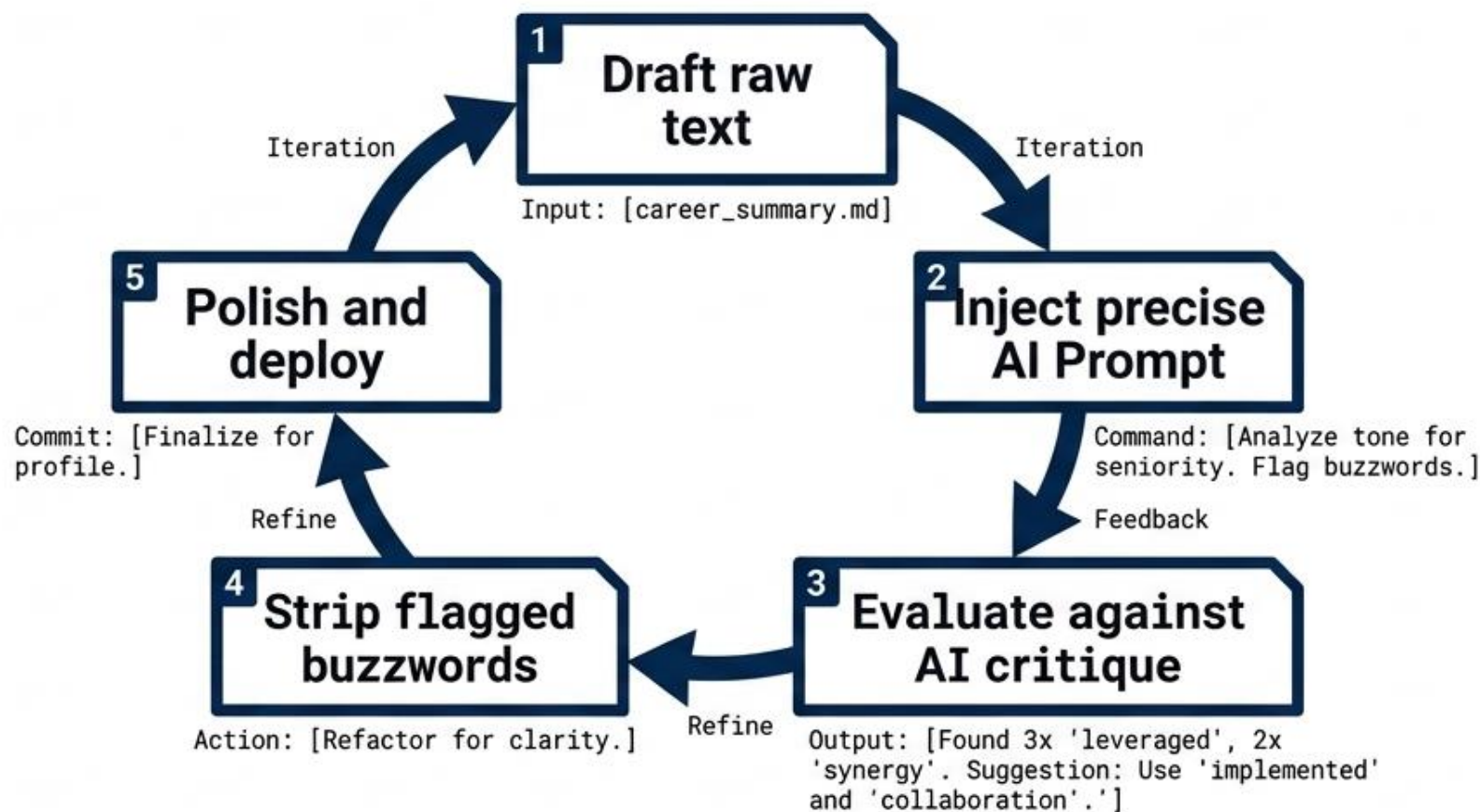
Constraints: Maximum 3-5 relevant hashtags. Tag teammates.
Never write a messy 5-post thread instead of one strong, cohesive post.

The AI Self-Review Loop: Continuous QA for Your Writing

You direct AI to debug code logic. Now, direct it to debug your career narrative.

Why AI beats a peer review:

- Friend says "looks good", misses jargon.
- AI reads against a strict rubric, flags exact buzzwords.
- AI is available at 11 PM before deployment.



This is a direct application of your Week 8 skill.
Direct the model for professional communication.

The Configuration Prompt for Long-Form Technical Drafts

Paste this configuration into Copilot Chat or Claude, replace [paste post] with your draft, and execute.

Act as a Hiring Manager seeking an AI Integration Specialist.

Review the following technical blog post draft.

Execute a strict QA against these constraints:

1. **THE HOOK:** Does it open with a specific business or technical friction point? Flag if it sounds academic.
2. **TOOL JUDGMENT:** Are the specific tools (e.g., n8n, Groq) explicitly justified by trade-offs?
3. **THE HARD PART:** Locate the narrative friction. If the author just says 'I learned a lot', flag for revision.
4. **JARGON STRIP:** Identify and remove generic AI hype buzzwords.

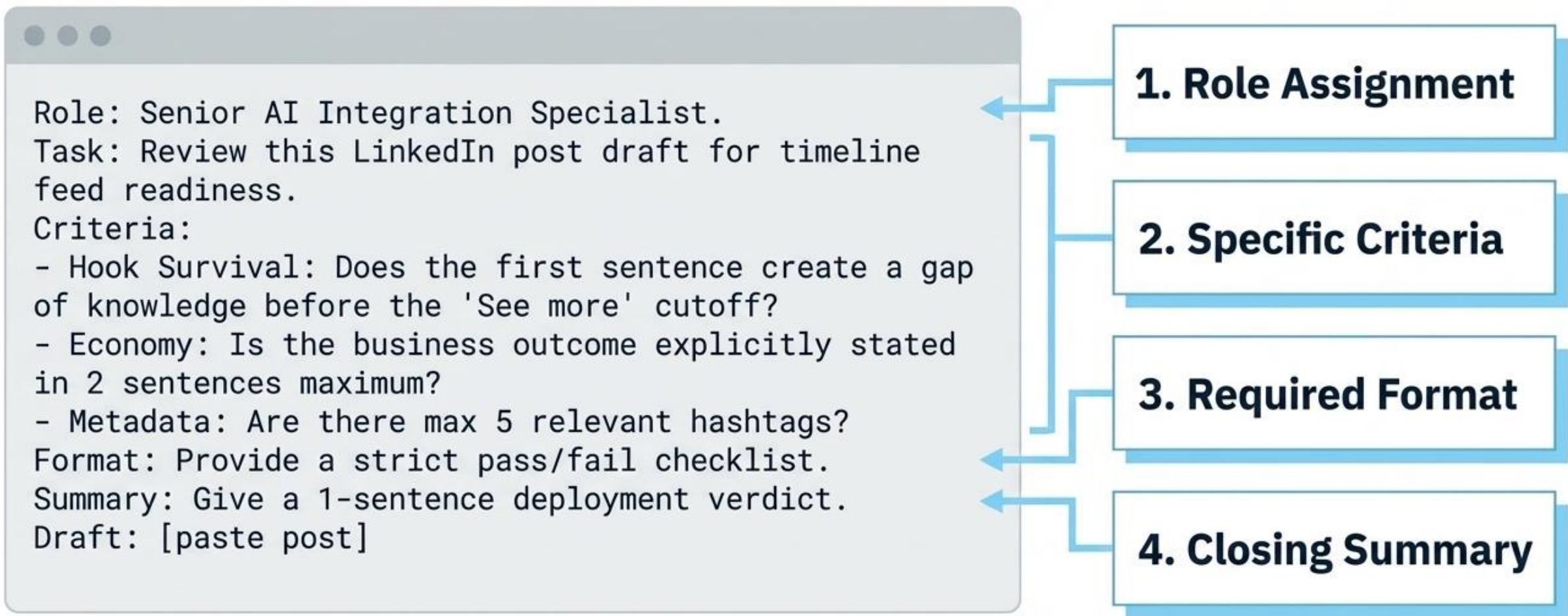
Output a structured critique matrix followed by one rewritten hook option.

Target Draft:

[paste post here]

Critical Detail: This prompt forces the AI to evaluate you as an AI Integration Specialist, not a Software Engineer. Tool choice and problem framing are prioritized over code elegance.

Re-Calibrating the Prompt for the LinkedIn Feed



```
Role: Senior AI Integration Specialist.  
Task: Review this LinkedIn post draft for timeline  
feed readiness.  
Criteria:  
- Hook Survival: Does the first sentence create a gap  
of knowledge before the 'See more' cutoff?  
- Economy: Is the business outcome explicitly stated  
in 2 sentences maximum?  
- Metadata: Are there max 5 relevant hashtags?  
Format: Provide a strict pass/fail checklist.  
Summary: Give a 1-sentence deployment verdict.  
Draft: [paste post]
```

1. Role Assignment

2. Specific Criteria

3. Required Format

4. Closing Summary

The Engineering behind the Prompt: It utilizes the exact 5-part framework from Week 8.
Same architecture, new domain.

Execution Backlog: Required vs. Career Upside

Required Pipeline (~30 mins)

- Execute the Slide 12 GitHub Profile checklist.
- Ensure NO previous checkpoint items are submitted here.

Optional Targets (Extra Credit)

- **The Blog Post:** 500-1000 words utilizing the 6-element architecture. Must clear the AI review prompt. Link required.
- **The LinkedIn Post:** 3-5 short paragraphs engineered for the 2-second scroll. Must clear the the AI review prompt. Screenshot required.

The **required minimum** is deliberately small. The **optional** work has **immense career upside**. Most candidates never publish their thought process — being the one who does is a massive differentiator.

Sprint Focus: Allocate the Rest of Class

A

Infrastructure Polish (Required)

Update photo, bio, pinned repos, and initialize the username/username Profile README repo.

Walk out with the baseline finished.

B

The Blog Draft (Extra Credit)

Open the 6-part architecture. Write a messy first draft of your capstone narrative.

Push it through the AI Prompt before class ends.

C

The Feed Draft (Extra Credit)

Utilize the funnel constraints.

Write a 3-5 paragraph LinkedIn execution.

Run the QA Prompt.

Operate in the open: Test these AI review prompts live right now, and share the most surprising piece of feedback the AI gives you in the class channel.